

Customer Journey Map

Stages, touchpoints and emotions across an experience

PROFESSIONAL DEFINITION

A Customer Journey Map visualises the end-to-end experience of a user achieving a goal — the sequence of stages and touchpoints, what they do at each, and the emotional highs and lows along the way. It exposes pain points and moments of opportunity across the whole experience, not a single screen.

WHO DEVELOPED IT

Rooted in service-design and CX practice; widely codified by the Nielsen Norman Group and service-design pioneers.

WHY IT WAS DEVELOPED

Organisations optimise individual touchpoints while the overall journey remains disjointed. Mapping the whole arc reveals where the experience actually breaks.

HOW IT IS USED

Define the persona and scenario, lay out stages left-to-right, plot actions, thoughts and an emotion curve, then mark pain points and opportunities for redesign.

WHEN IT IS USED

During empathy and definition, and when diagnosing where an existing experience fails.

BY WHOM IT IS USED

Service and UX designers, CX managers and operations teams.

INNOVATION RELATIVE TO PRIOR PRACTICE

It shifts attention from **isolated touchpoints to the whole journey** and its emotional arc, making cross-functional experience gaps visible.

FIGURE 1 · EXPERIENCE OVER TIME

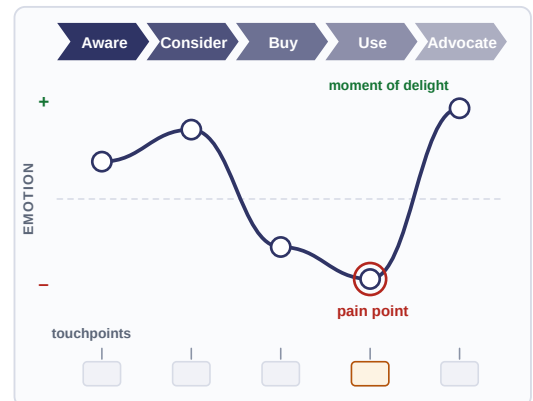


Figure 1. The emotional curve across journey stages exposes pain points — the design opportunities.

RELATED FRAMEWORKS IN THIS COURSE

Empathy Map *Slibrary 5*

Service Blueprint *Slibrary 8*

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SOURCES (HARVARD · CITE THEM RIGHT)

Gibbons, S. (2018) 'Journey Mapping 101', *Nielsen Norman Group*. Available at: <https://www.nngroup.com/articles/journey-mapping-101/> (Accessed: 20 July 2026).

Stickdorn, M. and Schneider, J. (2011) *This Is Service Design Thinking*. Amsterdam: BIS Publishers.